

Calendar of Forthcoming Electronics Fairs/Exhibitions/Seminars/Events

Name, Date and Venue	Topics to be covered	Contact address for details
2014 International CES January 7-10, 2014, Las Vegas, USA	Connects the industry and enables CE innovations to grow and thrive	Consumer Electronics Association (CEA), 1919 South Eads Street, Arlington, VA 22202 USA, Fax: (703) 907-7601, Phone: 866-233-7968 (U.S.), +1 301-631-3983 (outside U.S.) E-mail: CESinfo@CE.org
ELECRAMA-2014 January 8-12, 2014, Bangalore International Exhibition Centre (BIEC), Bengaluru	The world's largest power transmission and distribution biennial confluence	204, Swiss Complex, 33, Race Course Road, Bengaluru, Fax: (080) 2220 1317, Phone: 080-2220 1316/1318 E-mail: bangalore@leema.org Web: http://www.elecrama.com
Electronics For You Expo 2014 February, 2014, Pragati Maidan New Delhi	An expo covering the complete electronics ecosystem, including innovation, manufacturing, product design and product sales	Arun Singh, Electronics For You D-87/1, Okhla Industrial Area, Phase 1, New Delhi 110020, Fax: (011) 26817563; Phone: 26810601/2/3, E-mail: efyenq@efyindia.com; Web: www.efyexpo.com

Look up under 'Events' section in www.electronicaforum.com for a comprehensive list

Since this information is subject to change, all those interested are advised to ascertain the details from the organisers before making any commitment.

Snippets

IT job market to face slowdown, indicates India Inc.

India Inc. has stated that if the Indian job economy is not revived in time then this may lead to large-scale layoffs and much worse. As FICCI president Naina Lal Kidwai aptly stated before the meeting of the PM's Council of Trade and Industry, "Layoffs of contractual staff have already started and this could soon move to permanent employees. With the slowdown becoming more discernible, fresh hiring is already taking a hit. Unless the growth trajectory is reversed, we will be facing a grim employment scenario."

Excise duty-free sale of goods manufactured in India

New goods manufactured in India will be allowed to be sold as 'excise-free goods' in duty-free shops. The Central Board of Excise and Customs' vide a notification has provided for the excise duty-free sale of goods manufactured in India to the international passengers at the duty-free shops located in the arrival halls of the international airports.

India's rural telecom fund worth \$4.65 billion left unused

Around 10 years ago, a fund was created in order to link 638,596 villages in India with telecom and broadband connectivity. Contribution from private service providers to the fund was made mandatory. But, the whopping \$4.65 billion fund has not been used so far, according to the official data. The Parliament approved the scheme in 2002-03.

UP slated to sign ₹ 23 billion solar power deal

The UP government will enter into agreements to the tune of ₹ 23 billion with eight firms in the solar power sector. Until now, it is the biggest investment brought in the state by the government since the institution of Solar Power Policy 2013. The state's New and Renewable Energy Development Authority will sign an MoU with the National Hydroelectric Power Corporation for the establishment of a 100MW solar power plant in Jalaun.

the government of India, and Nigeria's permanent secretary in their ministry of Power, Godknows Igali.

The Bharat Heavy Electrical Limited (BHEL) would be beginning its preliminary studies for the establish-

ment of the power plants now as the agreement is official.

India, Israel mulling to set up joint innovation fund

Minister for Communications and IT,

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Kapil Sibal, recently led a delegation to Israel to market investment opportunities in the electronics system design and manufacturing (ESDM) domain in India.

The delegation met Israel's minister of Finance and minister of Communications to discuss setting up a joint innovation fund by India and Israel, with contributions of US\$ 1.5 million from each side.

ESC to come up with Africa-focus strategy

The Indian government sponsored Electronics and Computer Software Export Promotion Council (ESC) is in the process of creating a multi-pronged strategy for the export of electronics hardware and software to the African region.

"The region (Africa) is of paramount importance to future growth of the Indian electronics and IT sector on account of the fast digitalisation programme embarked by some of the African countries," D.K. Sareen, executive director, ESC, was quoted as saying by the *Business Standard*.

Planning Commission halts proposal to set up fab units

Expressing serious reservations that a huge 'undue' subsidy could go to the private sector, the Planning Commission of India has refused to accept Deity's ₹ 250 billion plan to set up semiconductor wafer fabrication manufacturing units in its present form.

This comes as a big blow to the industry that was optimistic of setting up of at least the first semiconductor wafer fabrication unit this year.